responsibilities as a net security provider. Its impact is visible in more projects, initiatives and activities.

A comprehensive maritime strategy naturally has a set of priorities, best depicted in terms of concentric circles. The core is a maritime infrastructure for the homeland, development of island assets, connectivity to immediate neighbours, and the capabilities brought to bear on a daily basis. With regard to its Neighbourhood First policy, what is of particular relevance are those initiatives which have an oceanic impact. The next circle includes the maritime space beyond India's waters and its immediate island neighbours like Sri Lanka, Maldives, Mauritius and Seychelles. On land, the restoration of connectivity to the extended neighbourhood is high in importance. They have direct implications for the ability of India to safeguard waters on a larger scale.

Then comes the real challenge – the revival of the Indian Ocean as a community that builds on its historical and cultural foundations. It is only by shaping cooperation across the Indian Ocean that India can hope to significantly influence events beyond it. How to make the ocean a more seamless and cooperative space is not only a larger regional objective, but one that would enhance the centrality of India. These challenges, even if differing in nature and importance, need to be addressed in parallel as they are to be self-supporting. The outermost circle takes India into the Pacific, engaging convergent interests to ensure core security while also promoting a stable periphery. Developing the policy exchanges, capability exercises and cooperation mechanisms in that regard is work under progress. It is the interplay of these circles that will determine not only India's maritime future but its larger strategic posture as well.

The Act East policy and greater maritime activities are already leading to the revival of ports on India's eastern seaboard that were extinguished during the colonial period. But to take full advantage of its location, it is vital that connectivity to maritime facilities is expanded beyond India's borders. Bangladesh and Myanmar both hold considerable potential in this regard. The undertaking of connectivity and infrastructure projects by offering Lines of Credit is already ongoing. While the Kaladan project to Sittwe port and the Trilateral Highway to Thailand are among the bigger